

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: North-western contact zone and evidence ladder

IRAN / CENTRAL ASIA

|

Hindu Kush -> Kabul-Gandhara -> Indus -> Taxila -> Punjab rivers

|

+--> armies + merchants + envoys + scripts + coin forms

EVIDENCE: royal inscription -> archaeology -> near-source report -> later narrative

RULE: geography enabled contact; imperial capacity and local politics shaped outcomes.

LIMIT: north-western campaigns must not be written as conquest of all India.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Achaemenid inclusion: claim, reach and limits

DARIUS DNa / XERXES XPh

|

Gandara + Hidush named among subject countries

|

Herodotus: tribute district + Indian/Gandarian contingents

v

SECURE: imperial claim, extraction and military connection

NOT SECURE: uniform borders, equal control or audited tribute totals

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Achaemenid mechanisms in the Indus frontier

IMPERIAL EXPANSION

|

satrapal mediation + tribute + garrisons + roads + multilingual administration

|

north-west linked more closely to Iranian imperial circuits

v

POSSIBLE LEGACIES: Aramaic-Kharosthi link, coin forms, political vocabulary

CAUTION: contact precedent is not proof that Mauryan institutions were copied.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Kharosthi and Aramaic: transmission without copying

ARAMAIC IMPERIAL ENVIRONMENT -> ADAPTATION -> KHAROSTHI

right-to-left script local language use

Achaemenid contact likely aided transmission

v

Earliest extensive secure Indian corpus is Mauryan/Ashokan and north-western.

DISTINCTION: origin process != date of surviving inscriptions.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Alexander's route: from Achaemenid world to Punjab

327 BCE: Hindu Kush / Swat campaigns

-> Aornos tradition -> Indus crossing -> Taxila alliance

326 BCE: Hydaspes (Jhelum) battle against Porus

-> Acesines (Chenab) -> Hydraotes (Ravi) -> Hyphasis (Beas)

325 BCE: lower Indus operations -> Gedrosian return

ROUTE RULE: several passes and valleys mattered; Khyber was not the only road.

SITE RULE: Bhir belongs to early Taxila; Sirkap is later Indo-Greek.

SOURCE RULE: surviving campaign narratives are later than the events.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Hydaspes: battle mechanism and political settlement

RIVER + MONSOON + PORUS'S ELEPHANTS

|

concealed crossing -> flank pressure -> close battle -> Macedonian victory

|

Porus restored and enlarged as subordinate regional ruler

v

MECHANISM: conserve manpower + retain local legitimacy + create a buffer

LIMIT: famous dialogue and exact tactics come through later literary shaping.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Why the army stopped at the Beas

BEAS HALT

- |-- accumulated casualties and campaign fatigue
- |-- monsoon, rivers, distance and supply strain
- |-- reports of strong eastern armies and elephants
- |-- soldiers' bargaining power after years of service
- `-- diminishing confidence in unlimited advance

VERDICT: a cumulative military-logistical-political refusal, not one fear factor.

LIMIT: Nanda army figures are remembered scale, not audited statistics.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Local agency: alliance, resistance and negotiated rule

AMBHI / TAXILA	PORUS / HYDASPES	MALLOI AND OTHERS
alliance and logistics	armed resistance	fortified resistance
rivalry used externally	defeat then restoration	severe local fighting

```

\          |          /
\----- LOCAL POLITICAL AGENCY -----/

```

External conquest advanced through existing conflicts, not across an empty frontier.

Alliance was strategic choice; resistance varied by polity and terrain.

Do not reduce north-western society to passive victims or willing collaborators.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Consequences: direct, indirect and overclaimed

DIRECT: short-lived Macedonian garrisons, satrapies, route knowledge, naval survey

NEAR-TERM: power reordering in the north-west and successor conflicts

LONGER CONTACT: coinage, art and diplomacy through later Hellenistic polities

NOT DIRECT: Mauryan empire, Indo-Greek rule, Gandhara art centuries later

|
v

Answer by chronology: event -> mechanism -> later transmission -> explicit limit.

Avoid 'opened India to the West'; the corridor already had older connections.

ASCHII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Mauryan and Seleucid bridge

ALEXANDER'S DEATH (323 BCE)

- > unstable satrapies and successor struggles
- > Chandragupta's north-western expansion
- > Seleucus conflict and treaty, c. 305-301 BCE
- > territorial adjustment + diplomatic exchange

MEGASTHENES: later-quoted observer at the Mauryan court

BRIDGE: Macedonian withdrawal created opportunity, not automatic Mauryan victory.

BOUNDARY: detailed Mauryan administration belongs to Topic 14.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Prelims distinction grid

Hydaspes = Jhelum Hyphasis = Beas
Acesines = Chenab Hydraotes = Ravi
Bhir = earliest historic Taxila phase
Sirkap = later Hellenistic-grid city; Sirsukh = Kushana phase
DNa/XPh = royal country lists; Herodotus = Greek narrative
Arrian = later writer using lost earlier accounts
Kharosthi = right-to-left; Aramaic linkage, not Alexander's invention
TRAP FILTER: date + source class + geography + degree of certainty.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Examiner-ready invasion answer spine

INTRO: define the north-western scale and separate Iranian from Macedonian phases.

BODY 1: geography and local polities

BODY 2: Achaemenid inscription/text evidence and administrative contact

BODY 3: Alexander route, Hydaspes settlement and Beas halt

BODY 4: direct consequences versus later Hellenistic developments

COUNTER: source distance, uncertain borders and exaggerated figures

CONCLUSION: connected frontier + local agency + selective institutional effects

WRITE: claim -> named evidence -> mechanism -> significance -> limit.